Lesson notes · for you

Codes are keys

Cyber security · Level 1 · Lesson 3

Time	Materials
15 min	Paper and a pen; A phone, with a parent or guardian

Learning goals

- Explain how two-step sign-in works.
- Turn it on for email, WhatsApp or a game, with an adult's help.
- Never share a one-time code.
- Keep backup codes safe, and know what a passkey is.

Activity: My account check

1. List (4 min): Write the names of the accounts you use: email, chat apps, games, school, social media.
2. Rank (3 min): Number them from the one that would hurt most if someone got in. Email usually comes first, because it resets the others.
3. Check (5 min): Next to each, write "two steps", "one step" or "don't know". Ask a partner how they would find out.
4. Plan (3 min): Circle one account to protect this week, and write who at home will help you.

Write account names only: never passwords, PINs or codes.

Discussion

- Why does a thief want the code, not just the password?
- What should you do about a prompt you didn't start?
- Where will you keep your backup codes?

Check yourself

- One account, and the second step I will add to it.

Try it this week

With a parent or guardian, turn on two-step sign-in for your email or WhatsApp. Write the backup codes or the PIN on paper, and keep it somewhere safe at home.

Worksheet

Codes are keys

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **At night your phone asks: "Is this you signing in?" You aren't signing in anywhere. What do you do?**

- ◯ Ignore it and go back to sleep
- ◯ Tap yes to make it stop
- ◯ Tap no, then change your password

2 **With two-step sign-in turned on, a thief who knows your password still can't get into your account on their own.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

3 **Put the steps to turn on WhatsApp's two-step verification in order.**

- ☐ Tap Account
- ☐ Choose a six-digit PIN and add a recovery email
- ☐ Open WhatsApp's Settings
- ☐ Tap Two-step verification, then Turn on

4 **Match each proof to its kind.**

Your password	• • • •	Something you have
Your phone	• • • •	Something you are
Your fingerprint	• • • •	Something you know

5 **Which of these are safe habits? Choose all that apply.**

- ☐ Keeping backup codes on paper at home
- ☐ Saving backup codes as a photo on your phone
- ☐ Tapping yes on a prompt only when you are signing in
- ☐ Never forwarding a code, even to a friend
- ☐ Reading a code out to a "bank" caller who says it's urgent

✎ **Which of your accounts would you protect with two-step sign-in first, and why?**

Check your answers

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1 **Tap no, then change your password**

A prompt you didn't start means someone has your password and is trying to get in.

2 **True**

They also need the second step — a code, a prompt on your phone or your fingerprint — and they don't have it.

3 **Top to bottom: 2, 4, 1, 3**

With the PIN set, someone who tricks you out of your text-message code still can't move your number to their phone.

4 **Your password — Something you know**
Your phone — Something you have
Your fingerprint — Something you are

Two-step sign-in is strongest when the two steps are different kinds: a thief who learns your password still doesn't have your phone or your finger.

5 **Never forwarding a code, even to a friend; Keeping backup codes on paper at home; Tapping yes on a prompt only when you are signing in**

Codes and prompts are the second lock, so they stay with you.